

Terminal Setup Before Class

A five minute checklist for your Linux terminal

The next class session uses a couple of command line utilities that read information about your machine's hardware. Most of what we look at that day already ships as part of a normal Linux install and needs nothing extra. Only one utility needs to be installed ahead of time, so class time is spent looking at your own machine rather than waiting on a package manager.

Already covered. If the verification command below already prints a result instead of “not found,” there is nothing else to do.

1. Install this before class

Table 1: Install commands by distribution.

Distribution	Command
Arch Linux	<code>sudo pacman -S dmidecode</code>
Artix Linux	<code>sudo pacman -S dmidecode</code>
Gentoo	<code>sudo emerge --ask sys-apps/dmidecode</code>
Void Linux	<code>sudo xbps-install -S dmidecode</code>
Xubuntu	<code>sudo apt install dmidecode</code>

If you are on a distribution not listed here, install the package named `dmidecode` through your package manager's equivalent command.

2. Verify it worked

Run the following, and confirm it prints a result rather than “not found” or a permission error.

```
which dmidecode
sudo dmidecode -t memory | head -20
```

A working result looks like one or more blocks of fields such as Size, Type, Speed, and Manufacturer, each with an actual value rather than every field reading “Not Specified” or “Unknown.”

Nothing but Unknown fields? Some machines, particularly virtual machines, do not expose full memory details to this tool no matter what you try. If most fields print Unknown or Not Specified, mention that before class rather than spending time trying to fix it, since it is a property of the machine, not a setup mistake.

No sudo on this machine? If you are on a shared or managed machine without sudo access, or you run into a permission error you cannot resolve, message me before class and we will sort out an alternative for that session.